

Respect Yourself and Others: Wrap-Up, Featuring Teela Jackson

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Pat Summitt said that ambition can transform you. The starting point of ambition is self-respect. Pat also reminds us that there is no such thing as self-respect without respect for others. Individual success is a myth. No one succeeds all by herself.

In this module, we learned that peer-to-peer accountability can be an effective tool where we hold each other accountable for results. But for peer-to-peer accountability to work, three things must already be in place—trust, healthy debate, and commitment. Without these principles, our team will not be ready for peer-to-peer accountability to work within our system.

Second, respect starts with you and the respect you have for yourself. Your team needs a healthy you, and taking care of yourself reflects your level of self-respect. After all, if you don't respect yourself, you aren't giving your team the respect they deserve because you aren't going to be able to give it your all.

Finally, we were reminded of some detrimental respect-busting behaviors like gossip, negativity, not being on time, and taking credit for other people's work. Become aware of these behaviors that diminish your respect capital, and be intentional to not engage in them.

Pat said, "Self-respect can be hard won. I know. It's an ongoing process." But once you attain it, it will bear you up through almost anything, whether you're dealing with a difficult parent, teasing from others, self-doubt, or ordinary work tensions. In critical situations, we all ask ourselves the same silent question, "Do I deserve to succeed?"

Under pressure, uncertainty can creep into the subconscious of even the most outwardly confident person, including me.

If you haven't developed self-respect and mutual respect with those around you, the whisper is deep down ... *you know you don't deserve it.*

The next time you ask yourself—"Do I deserve to succeed?"—make sure the answer is yes.